

What it costs to build a house in Nigeria in 2026

Lagos building costs per square metre and by house type, in naira, pounds and dollars, with the stage-by-stage split we use for payments. Figures verified 2026-10-02; currency at CBN official rate on 2026-10-02 (₦1,767 = £1, ₦1,329 = \$1). Building only: excludes land, approvals, external works and furniture.

1. Cost per square metre

Finish level	Naira per m ²	Pounds per m ²	Dollars per m ²	Typically includes
Basic finish	₦150,000–₦220,000	£85–£125	\$113–\$166	Local tiles, standard doors and fittings, PVC ceilings, emulsion paint.
Standard finish	₦220,000–₦330,000	£125–£187	\$166–\$248	Good porcelain tiles, POP ceilings, quality sanitary ware, aluminium windows.
Premium finish	₦330,000–₦450,000	£187–£255	\$248–\$339	Imported finishes, feature lighting, fitted kitchen and wardrobes, smart wiring. High-end Ikoyi/Banana Island builds can exceed ₦450,000/m ² .

2. Cost by house type

House type	Floor area	Basic (₦m)	Standard (₦m)	Premium (₦m)	Standard (£)	Standard (\$)
2-bedroom bungalow	~90 m ²	13.5–20	20–29.5	29.5–40.5	£11k–£17k	\$15k–\$22k
3-bedroom bungalow	~130 m ²	19.5–28.5	28.5–43	43–58.5	£16k–£24k	\$21k–\$32k
4-bedroom bungalow	~170 m ²	25.5–37.5	37.5–56	56–76.5	£21k–£32k	\$28k–\$42k
4-bedroom duplex	~280 m ²	42–61.5	61.5–92.5	92.5–126	£35k–£52k	\$46k–\$70k
5-bedroom duplex	~350 m ²	52.5–77	77–115.5	115.5–157.5	£44k–£65k	\$58k–\$87k

3. Where the money goes, stage by stage

We split payments the same way: you pay for one stage at a time, released only after our inspection team signs off the previous one (you can add an independent inspector of your own).

Stage	Share of build cost	What it covers
Design, approvals and site preparation	5–10%	Drawings, structural design, soil test, building permit, clearing and setting out.
Foundation	10–15%	Excavation, blinding, footings or raft, foundation walls, DPC. More on waterlogged or reclaimed land.

Stage	Share of build cost	What it covers
Frame and blockwork	20-30%	Columns, beams, blockwork, lintels; for a duplex also the first-floor slab and stairs.
Roofing	8-12%	Timber or steel trusses, covering (stone-coated or aluminium), fascia and gutters.
Services	10-15%	Electrical wiring and fittings, plumbing, septic or soakaway, water storage.
Finishing	30-40%	Plaster, screed, tiles, ceilings, paint, doors, windows, sanitary ware, kitchen.

4. Not included: budget for these too

- Land: from about ₦15m a plot in Ikorodu to over ₦1bn in Ikoyi.
- Approvals: Lagos building permit and related fees, set by size and location.
- External works (fence, gate, paving, borehole, septic tank, generator house): usually 10-20% extra.
- Furniture, appliances and solar/inverter systems.
- A contingency of 5-10% for price movements and choices during the build.

5. Five rules that protect your money

- ✓ Verify the land title through a lawyer before you pay for land.
- ✓ Contract with a registered company, not an individual.
- ✓ Get an itemised, open-book bill of quantities and compare it with market prices.
- ✓ Pay in stages, each released only after the stage has been inspected and documented.
- ✓ See the site for yourself: live camera, dated weekly reports and video walk-rounds.

Get a figure for your own plot

These ranges are for planning. Your real cost comes from a bill of quantities priced on your drawings and soil test. Book a free 20-minute consultation by video call or WhatsApp at a time that suits your time zone: artemisatelierltd.com/build-from-abroad · WhatsApp +234 803 350 2393.

Live versions of these figures, with today's exchange rate and current material prices: artemisatelierltd.com/guides/cost-of-building-a-house-in-nigeria. Sources: Build With Ease (May 2026), Prioni (June 2026), Nigeria Building Cost 2026, Artemis Atelier material price tracker.